

Classic Chicago Magazine

Production & Publishing Standards

1. Overview

Classic Chicago Magazine is a static HTML website — there is no content management system (CMS). Articles are hand-built as HTML pages and published via Git. This document describes the conventions, workflow, and responsibilities for the production team.

The Production Team

- **John Bartlett** — Tech lead. Builds and deploys the site.
- **Adrian Naves** — Layout. Assists with article HTML and visual formatting.
- **Annie Delfosse** — DateBook curator. Maintains the DateBook page.
- **Ana Baca** — Publishing support. Article uploads and About the Town photos.

2. Site Structure

Folder Organization

Each edition lives in a date-stamped folder. Each article lives in a subfolder named after the article slug:

editions/YYYY-MM-DD/article-slug/index.html

editions/YYYY-MM-DD/article-slug/photo.jpg

Article Slugs

Slugs are lowercase, hyphenated versions of the article title:

"Jessie Mueller: Evanston Tony Winner" → jessie-mueller

"Two Sisters and a Piano at Writers Theatre" → two-sisters-and-a-piano

Shared Assets

- Logo, favicon: root directory
- Ad images: /ads/ — never inside edition folders
- Article images: same folder as the article's index.html

Relative Paths from Articles

- Root assets: ../../../
- Sibling article links: ../{sibling-slug}/
- Ad assets: ../../../ads/

3. Building an Article

HTML Template Structure

Every article follows the same template. Reference an existing article when building new ones.
Key sections:

- Head: GA4 analytics (always enabled, never commented out), Google Fonts, CSS
- Header: logo, main nav (Home, DateBook, Astrochart, hamburger menu)
- Article: category label, h1 title, meta (By Author · Date), hero figure
- article-intro class: first paragraph in larger font
- article-body class: remaining paragraphs with inline figure elements
- Feedback widget with dynamic environment detection
- About the Author link (if author is in about.html)
- Edition nav: ← Previous and Next → links
- Footer: social icons + copyright
- Scripts: hamburger toggle, keyboard nav (N/P/Space/PgDn/PgUp/?)

What NOT to Include

- No author popups or location popups
- No Splide.js carousels — use inline figures instead
- No commented-out GA4 — analytics must always be active

Navigation Links

- Nav order must match the homepage display order.
- Article 1 (hero): Previous → Home
- Last article: Next → Home
- Middle articles: link to adjacent article slugs

4. Publishing Workflow

Branch Strategy

- **dev2:** All new work starts here. Safe to experiment.
- **dev:** Staging. Judy reviews here. Vercel preview URL available.
- **master:** Production. Live at chicagoclassicmag.com. Never commit directly.

Judy's Approval

Nothing moves from dev to master without Judy's editorial sign-off. Share the Vercel preview URL for review. Once approved, John merges to master.

5. The Homepage

- **Date line:** Update to the new edition date.
- **Hero section:** Wrap the entire hero in a single link so both image and text are clickable. For portrait photos, use object-position: center 15%-25% to keep the face above the text overlay.
- **Card grid:** Remaining articles. The hero does NOT also appear as a card.
- **Past Editions:** Move outgoing edition to top. Keep no more than 4 past editions.

6. DateBook

DateBook is maintained by Annie Delfosse and linked from the main nav.

- Annie submits updates to John by email.
- Updates are built into the existing DateBook HTML page.

7. Recurring Columns

- **About the Town (Philip Vidal):** Comes in at end of month. Ana Baca handles photo processing and placement.

8. Tools & Access

- **GitHub:** [JohnBartlett/article](https://github.com/JohnBartlett/article) — source of truth for all site files.
 - **Vercel preview (dev):** article-git-dev-johns-projects-e5fce345.vercel.app
 - **Dev2 preview:** article-git-dev2-johns-projects-e5fce345.vercel.app
 - **Production:** chicagoclassicmag.com (master branch, Cloudflare)
 - **Email:** Articles and photos arrive at john.bartlett@gmail.com and judycbross@aol.com
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